

MEMORANDUM OF UNDERSTANDING

KNOW ALL MEN BY THESE PRESENTS:

This Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) executed and entered into this MAR 04 2026 day of 2026 in QUEZON CITY, Philippines, by and between:

DEPARTMENT OF SOCIAL WELFARE AND DEVELOPMENT, a government agency **duly organized under the existing laws of the Republic of the Philippines**, with principal office address at IBP Road, Batasan Pambansa Complex, Constitution Hills, Quezon City, represented herein by its **Secretary, REXLON T. GATCHALIAN**, hereinafter referred to as the **"DSWD"**;

- and -

The **UNIVERSITY OF THE PHILIPPINES**, the national university of the Republic of the Philippines created by virtue of Act No. 1870, as amended by Republic Act No. 9500, with principal office address at Quezon Hall, University of the Philippines Diliman, Quezon City, represented herein by its President, **ANGELO A. JIMENEZ**, hereinafter referred to as the **"U.P."**

(DSWD and U.P. shall individually be referred to herein as a "Party" and collectively as the "Parties.")

WITNESSETH THAT:

RECITALS

WHEREAS, DSWD is the primary government agency mandated to develop, administer, and implement comprehensive social welfare and protection programs and poverty-reduction solutions designed to uplift the living conditions and empower the poor, vulnerable and disadvantaged children, youth, women, older persons, persons with disabilities, families or persons in crisis or at-risk, and communities needing assistance; and as the lead agency in disaster response cluster, DSWD is mandated to ensure the provision of emergency support services and public assistance, during or immediately after a disaster in order to save lives, reduce health impacts, ensure public safety, and meet the basic subsistence needs of the affected population;

WHEREAS, Section 8 of the Implementing Rules and Regulations of Republic Act No. 9433, otherwise known as the *Magna Carta for Public Social Workers*, provides that the Social Work Management and Consultative Council shall be headed by DSWD, including responsibilities related to career development, competency enhancement, and workforce strengthening of public social workers;

WHEREAS, U.P.'s mandate, as the National University under Republic Act No. 9500 (University of the Philippines Charter of 2008), is to lead in teaching and research in the social sciences, providing scholarly and technical assistance as a public service university to the government, and serving the Filipino nation as its social responsibility;

WHEREAS, Republic Act No. 10650 (Open Distance Learning Act) institutionalized Open and Distance Learning in tertiary education and entrusted U.P. Open University with the role of assisting and providing expertise to certain national government agencies in the performance of their functions;

WHEREAS, the U.P. College of Education and College of Social Work and Community Development are U.P. Diliman colleges which are Centers of Excellence in the Philippines in the field of teacher education and social work and community development.

WHEREAS, DSWD and U.P. recognize the importance of a **systems-based approach to social development**, one that intentionally links education, research, knowledge generation, innovation, and field practice to improve policies, programs, and service delivery for vulnerable populations;

WHEREAS, the Parties acknowledge existing collaborations, including UP-led training initiatives and microcredential programs for social welfare personnel, and recognize the value of expanding these into more integrated, outcomes-oriented, and impact-driven partnerships;

WHEREAS, the Parties recognize the potential of further collaborative work across priority social development and protection areas, supported by research, learning exchanges, knowledge generation, and community-based documentation, to strengthen program convergence, evidence-based implementation, and impact for vulnerable sectors, including but not limited to initiatives addressing women, youth, community development, food security, poverty reduction, and similar national priorities;

WHEREAS, the Parties acknowledge the Expanded Tertiary Education Equivalency and Accreditation Program (ETEEAP) as an inspiration for possible complementary pathways for recognizing prior learning and professional experience, and agree to pursue further consultations on this area;

NOW THEREFORE, for and in consideration of the foregoing premises, the Parties commit on the following:

I. OBJECTIVES

This Memorandum of Understanding aims to establish a strategic and system-level collaboration between DSWD and U.P. to strengthen social development outcomes through:

- a. The co-development and delivery of learning programs, courses, and social development interventions that integrate instruction, research, knowledge management, and field practice;
- b. The strengthening of institutional, workforce, and community capacities through scalable, blended, campus-based, regional, and distance learning approaches; and
- c. The generation, documentation, and application of evidence, good practices, and innovations to support policy enhancement, program convergence, and service delivery effectiveness.

II. COMMITMENTS

To facilitate academic and institutional cooperation and advance a mutually reinforcing collaboration across learning, research, and public service, the Parties express their intent to explore possible areas of cooperation, subject to applicable laws and policies, including ways to:

1. Engage in training for course development and course delivery for the upskilling of professionals and paraprofessionals in DSWD and its stakeholders, drawing on expertise from U.P., as applicable;
2. Tap expertise from both Parties in the co-creation of learning modules, curricula, and instructional resources, including those focusing on women, youth, community, and social development, as well as emerging and cross-cutting social issues;
3. Support the use and strengthening of learning management systems (LMS), digital platforms, and blended modalities to expand reach and sustainability of capacity-building initiatives;
4. Participate in the development of microcredentialing, continuing education, and other non-formal learning pathways, including exploratory discussions on ETEEAP

or other programs, subject to U.P., CHED, and other applicable government policies;

- 5. Work jointly in knowledge management, research utilization, and documentation of best practices, lessons learned, and innovations to support learning, policy development, and program improvement;
- 6. Undertake campus-based, regional, field-embedded, and blended learning initiatives that reinforce the link between theory, research, and practice;
- 7. Engage DSWD as a potential field placement and learning site for U.P. faculty and students in social work and related disciplines, subject to prior written approval from DSWD and applicable laws, policies and guidelines; and

III. IMPLEMENTATION OF SPECIFIC PROGRAMS

The implementation of any specific program, course, project, or collaborative work in relation to this MOU shall be made under a Memorandum of Agreement (MOA) or other separate written agreement that shall specify the purpose, covenants, rights, and obligations, participating institutions or offices, and other terms and conditions.

IV. NON-BINDING EFFECT

This MOU is merely an expression of the wishes of the PARTIES to discuss possible areas of cooperation, hence, it shall not create any binding legal rights or obligations among and between the PARTIES or with any third person.

V. EXECUTION IN COUNTERPARTS

This MOU may be signed in counterparts or duplicate originals, each of which is identical to the other, and shall be considered as equally authentic.

VI. EFFECTIVITY

This MOU shall be effective for a period of one (1) year from its date of execution, unless terminated earlier in writing by either Party, with at least thirty (30) calendar days' prior written notice to the other Party.

VII. POINT PERSONS

DSWD	U.P.
Atty. Justin Caesar Anthony D. Batocabe, CESE	Dr. Lorraine Pe Symaco Vice President for Academic Affairs
swidb@dswd.gov.ph	ovpaa@up.edu.ph
DSWD Academy IBP Road, Batasan Pambansa Complex, Constitution Hills Quezon City	University of the Philippines 3F North Wing Quezon Hall University of the Philippines Diliman Quezon City 1101

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, the parties, through their respective duly authorized representatives, have executed and signed this Memorandum of Understanding on the date and at the place first written above.

UNIVERSITY OF THE PHILIPPINES

DEPARTMENT OF SOCIAL WELFARE
AND DEVELOPMENT

By:

By:



ANGELO A. JIMENEZ
President



REXLON T. GATCHALIAN
Secretary



LORRAINE P. SYMACO, Ph.D
Vice President for Academic Affairs

Signed in the presence of:



DENISE B. BERNOS BRAGAS, MD, RSW
Undersecretary, RSIDG

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

REPUBLIC OF THE PHILIPPINES)
.....) S.S.

BEFORE ME, a Notary Public for and in Quezon City this 4th day of March 2026 2026 personally appeared:

Name	Valid ID	Issued at/on
Secretary Rexlon T. Gatchalian	DSWD ID No 23-0012	Quezon City / 11 Aug 2025

He is known to me to be the same person who executed the foregoing Memorandum of Understanding, consisting of five (5) pages, including this page on which this acknowledgment is written and signed on each and every page thereof by him and his witness, and he acknowledged to me that the same is his free and voluntary act and deed as well as the Party he represents.

Doc. No. 17 ;
Page No. 7 ;
Book No. II ;
Series of 2026.

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

REPUBLIC OF THE PHILIPPINES)
Quezon City) S.S.

BEFORE ME, a Notary Public for and in Quezon City this MAR 04 2026 day of 2026 personally appeared:

Name	Valid ID	Issued at/on
Angelo A. Jimenez	Phil. Passport: S6029868A	Manila on 21 June 2023

He known to me to be the same persons who executed the foregoing Memorandum of Understanding, consisting of five (5) pages, including this page on which this acknowledgment is written and signed on each and every page by him and his witness, and he acknowledged to me that the same is his free and voluntary act and deed as well as the Party he represents.

Doc. No. 10 :
Page No. 5 :
Book No. II :
Series of 2026.

ATTY. FELIZARDO M. IBARRA
Notary Public for Quezon City Until Dec. 31, 2026
Roll No. 80835
PTR No. 8353947, 1/6/26 QC
IBP No. 331161, December 19, 2023*
MCLE Comp. No. VIII-0000973/ until April 14, 2026+
ADM Matter No. NP. 088 / (2025-2026)